action. The decision itself does not apply in this case, because it cannot be isolated from the decision maker's political worldview.

When attempting to translate the Israeli Right and Left's political worldview and vision into the language of someone who is not a politician but rather a practitioner—someone who approaches problems from a pragmatic rather than an ideological perspective—one must ask, "What is the degree of risk that each of these parties is willing to undertake in order to ensure the existence of Israel as a Jewish and democratic state, while simultaneously providing an appropriate response to the demands of the Palestinians?" Risk assessment should propel us to choose a preferred course of action with regard to most of the issues on the table, but there will remain "soft" issues anchored in the world of values and in the historical memory of each side, and these cannot be dealt with through some kind of compromised partition.

Nonetheless, over time, from the First World War until today, the progress graph of the Zionist movement and later of the State of Israel shows steady and continuous advancement—with regard to territory, demography, the economy, science and technology, the military, and international standing. It is important that we be aware of this, because the stronger side has greater safety margins and the options available to it are more varied.

In its routine role, intelligence focuses on providing advance warnings of the enemy's intentions to wage war, and on gathering and assessing information about its capabilities. However, another important role of intelligence, which the general public is not always aware of, is to identify and encourage reconciliatory trends and intentions among our enemies that signal a possible willingness to accept our existence here and enter into peace negotiations with us. In the cases of Egypt and Jordan, intelligence identified their willingness to negotiate peace, succeeded in persuading then-leaders Begin and Rabin, and even served as a matchmaker at the beginning of the process in the case of Egypt and as an active participant in the negotiations right up to the signing of the peace treaty in the case of Jordan.

Regarding Israel's intelligence relations with other countries, the Mossad has a clear advantage over other branches of intelligence by virtue of its function and because of its direct subordination to the political leader, the prime minister (as opposed to Military Intelligence, which is subordinate to the chief of staff). In theory, there is a very clear division of roles and authority between the Foreign Ministry, which deals with diplomatic